

THE TIP

Draft 2 - branching sequence

INT. PORT AUTHORITY OFFICE - NIGHT

VIC meets **DANA** in the stairwell they always use when Dana has something she shouldn't. Dana presses a folded shipping manifest into Vic's hand before either of them says a word.

DANA

Whatever you do with this, it didn't come from me.

VIC

It never does.

[PRODUCTION NOTE: one shoot day, six crew. Two actors and a stairwell.]

Vic has three ways she can play this. Going at the shipping foreman directly with what's on the manifest takes us into **Foreman Confrontation**. Sitting on the warehouse first to see who actually shows up takes us into **Warehouse Stakeout**. Working the harbour front for talk before she tips her hand anywhere takes us into **Fish Market Inquiry**.

FOREMAN CONFRONTATION

INT. SHIPPING OFFICE - DAY

Vic drops the manifest on REYES's desk without any preamble. He doesn't even look surprised, which tells her everything the paperwork didn't.

REYES

You're going to want to sit down for this part.

By the time he's done, Reyes has talked, and he has told her more than he meant to. They both know it.

[PRODUCTION NOTE: one shoot day, six crew.]

However that lands, it lands here: this one runs straight on into **Foreman Ending**.

FOREMAN ENDING

INT. SHIPPING OFFICE - CONTINUOUS

Vic folds the manifest back up and pockets it. Reyes doesn't get up and doesn't stop her. Whatever happens between the two of them after tonight isn't part of this - the sequence ends with her walking out the same door she came in.

WAREHOUSE STAKEOUT

EXT. HARBOR WAREHOUSE - NIGHT

Vic settles into the car across the lot, engine off, watching the loading doors for anything that doesn't belong. Nothing moves for a long time. Then, close to dawn on the second night, a truck she doesn't recognise backs up to the doors.

[PRODUCTION NOTE: two shoot days, we need the stakeout covered across a wet night and a clear one before it cuts together. Twelve crew, the biggest unit in the sequence, and that is after trimming it.]

She waits until the lot is empty again, then goes in. Straight on into The Ledger.

THE LEDGER

INT. HARBOR WAREHOUSE - LATER THAT NIGHT

Vic slips through the side door and finds the ledger exactly where the manifest said it would be. She reads two pages standing up, and whatever is on the second one stops her.

It's still open in her hands when she reaches for the phone. She doesn't call Hale. She calls the number written inside the back cover, and the voice that answers sends her straight back across the water.

[PRODUCTION NOTE: one shoot day, seven crew.]

That takes us into Foreman Confrontation. Open only if Reyes has already talked.

FISH MARKET INQUIRY

EXT. HARBOR FISH MARKET - NIGHT

Vic works the harbour front the long way round, manifest folded out of sight, asking the same three questions of anyone still out at this hour. Nobody is in a hurry to talk to her and nobody has to be.

By the time one of them finally says something worth hearing, it is about a truck that left two hours ago. The trail is cold and she knows it. The sequence ends with Vic walking back to the car with nothing to show for the night.

[PRODUCTION NOTE: one shoot day, five crew. She never goes inside anywhere and never handles a thing, so we are not tied to this address - any stretch of the harbour front after dark plays it.]